DALHOUSIE HACKER'S SOCIETY

EMPOWERING INNOVATION.

Presents

HACK TO THE FUTURE

HACKATHON

WELCOME!

Start

Prizes

$1000

Sponsors

digital nova scotia

SHIFTKEY LABS

Today featuring

- **Judges**: Local tech companies, DNS, & Dal CS faculty.
- **Food:** Pizza lunch, continental breakfast, & coffee coffee coffee.
- **Fun**: Programming, teamwork, the creative-process, prizes & free food.

Ears open & Eyes front

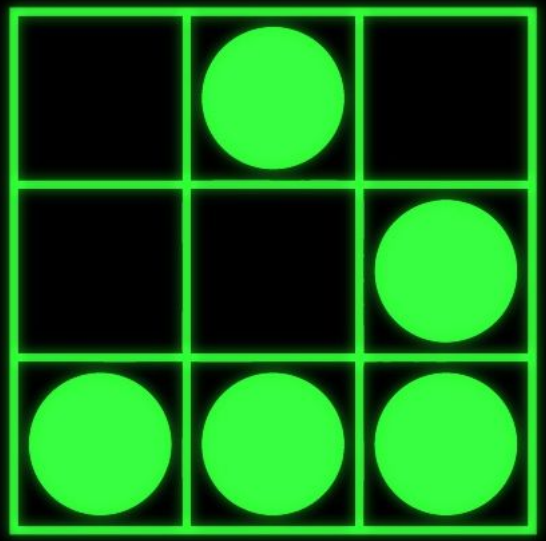
Hackathon Schedule

Time	Session
9:00 AM	Registration and Coffee
9:30 AM	Problem Statement
9:45 AM	Team Setup
10:00 AM	Work Session
12:00 PM	Working Lunch
3:00 PM	Submission Deadline
3:15 PM	Judging Starts
5:00 PM	Prizes + Networking

prizes == True

stakes = incentive

Team Registration



Hosted by…

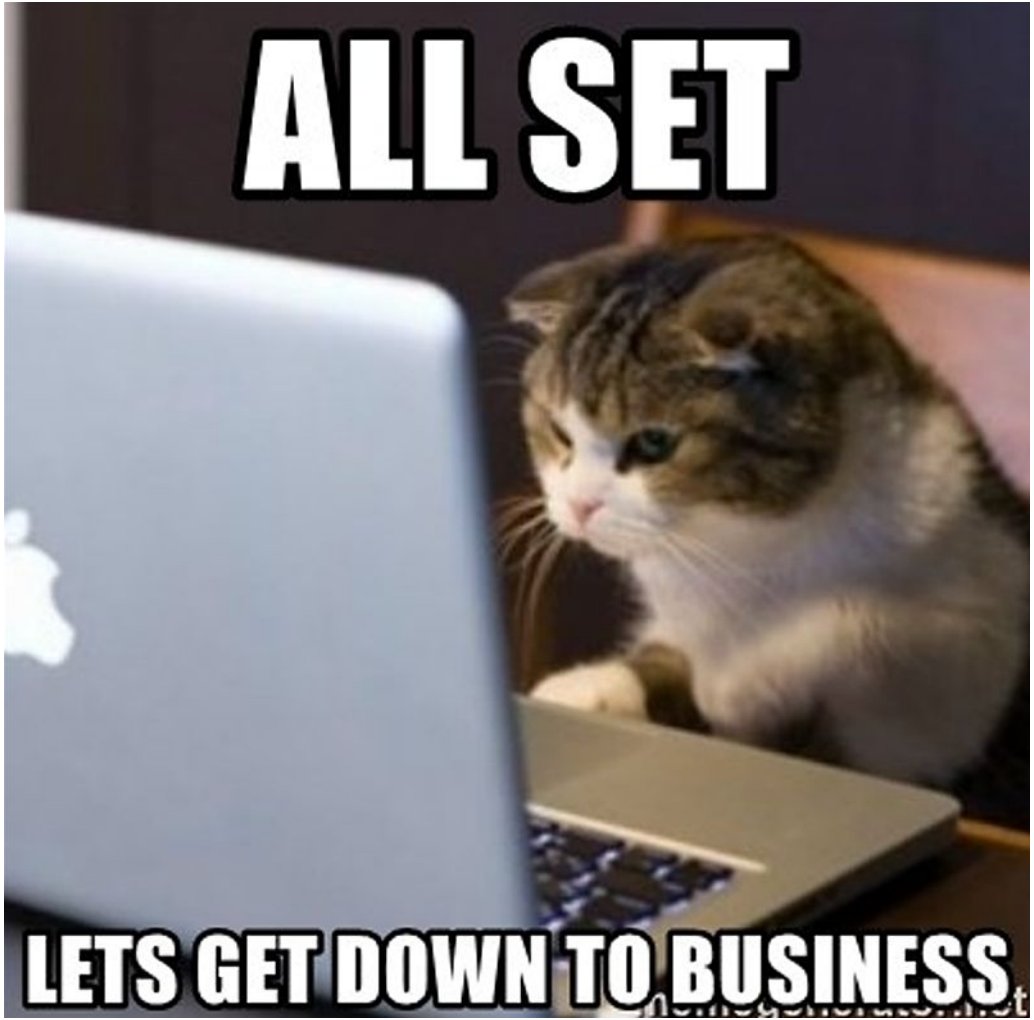
Dalhousie Hackers Society

Mission: To create an inclusive community on campus for CS students that empowers them to achieve their goals academically and in their careers.

What we do: Host hackathons, workshops and field trips to employers. Develop partnerships that connect students with the jobs that matter to them. As well as community outreach & community building.

Partnerships: Digital Nova Scotia, ShiftKey Labs, DCS Faculty, DeepSense, HanaTech & growing…

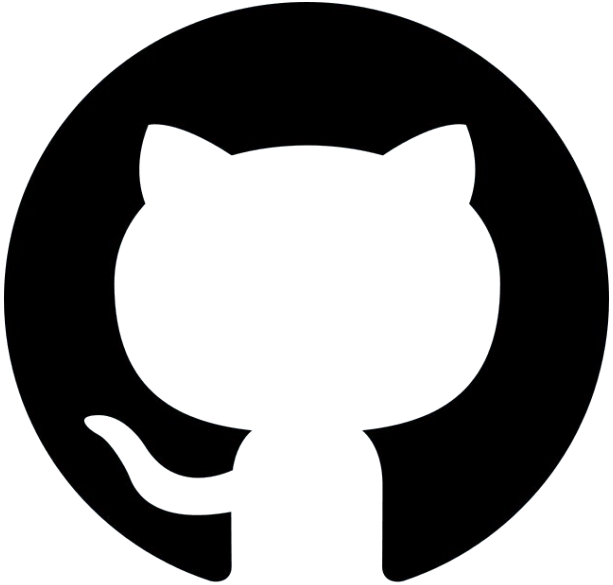
Members: 70+ and growing. Join today! We are also looking for serious executive council applicants.


ALL SET
LETS GET DOWN TO BUSINESS

IMPORTANT: Hackathon Github Repo

You can locate mission critical information here:

https://github.com/0x00wolf/hack-to-the-future



Problem Statement!

The Question:

How can technology shape a future where productivity and well-being go hand in hand?

The Challenge:

We challenge you to build an innovative solution that helps university students and/or early professionals succeed academically, or in their careers, without sacrificing their mental or physical health.

Your team must address a real-world challenge related to healthy living or educational/career excellence. We are looking for tools that empower users to stop choosing between success and sanity, and instead, leverage technology to achieve both.

Key Focus Areas:

Your solution should accomplish **any or all** of the following:

- demonstrate how technology can support smarter decision-making,
- improve daily habits,
- or create more balanced, efficient, and fulfilling lifestyles.

Consider focusing on:

- **Wellness & Balance:** Tools that prevent burnout, encourage mindfulness, or promote healthy habits amidst a busy schedule.
- **Organization & Focus:** Solutions that reduce cognitive load, streamline workflows, or help users master their time.
- **Career Readiness & Growth:** Platforms that guide professional development, skill-building, or networking in a sustainable way.
- **Academic Excellence**: Resources that make learning more effective, engaging, or less stressful.

Judging Rubric

- **Find it on the Github repo.**
- Innovation & novelty are 40%.
- All scores out of 10 by judges & then weighted.
- Don’t need a finished product to win:
  - Consider the fact you have a short time to build something and develop a presentation.
  - You can build a working prototype, a mock up of a working prototype with some demonstrative features to show your idea, a Figma wireframe, etc.

Category	Weight	Description & Guiding Questions
1. Innovation & Novelty	**40%**	**The Big Idea: How fresh, original, and creative is the concept?** • **Conceptual Originality:** Is this a novel solution or a unique twist? Does it identify a problem others have missed? • **Human-Centric Creativity:** Does the idea reflect genuine human insight and lived experience? Ideas that appear to be generated by AI and lack personal depth will be penalized. • **Future Potential:** Does this idea have legs? Could it grow into something meaningful with more time? *Note: A team with slides only can still score highly here if their idea is brilliant and original.*
2. Viability & Execution Path	**20%**	**The Plan: How well does the team understand what it would take to build this?** • **Scope Awareness:** Is the idea appropriately scoped for a 6-hour hackathon (realistic) or wildly overambitious? • **Technical Clarity:** Does the team have a clear vision of the tech stack, APIs, or tools needed to build their solution? • **MVP Definition:** Can they articulate what a minimum viable product would look like and how their current prototype/demo fits into that vision?
3. Prototype Completion	**5%**	**The Build: How much did they actually accomplish in 6 hours?** • **Tangible Output:** Did they produce *something* functional, even if small? A working button, a script that runs, a Figma flow that connects? • **Fidelity:** How polished is their prototype relative to the time constraint? *Note: Due to the advent of generative AI, this metric has been kept intentionally low for scoring. However, we still want to encourage teams with a strong programming skillset to something original, which should be rewarded.*
4. Scaleability	**15%**	**Does the concept have the potential for mass adoption?** • **Ability for solution to scale:** Does the idea have legs? Is the market for this idea generally adoptable, or does it serve for a niche audience? Could the idea be scaled for a growing userbase?
5. Presentation & Pitch	**20%**	**The Story: How effectively did the team communicate their idea and demo?** • **Problem/Solution Clarity:** Can they clearly explain the problem and their innovative solution in 3-4 minutes? • **Demo Effectiveness:** Did they show what they built (even if it's a Figma walkthrough or a terminal output)? • **Passion & Enthusiasm:** Does the team seem excited about their idea? Can they speak to it with genuine ownership?

Good luck!

Get hacking…